1. Executive summary

This FICTITIOUS report was written for testing the CTI platform. Between 3 and 9 March a financially motivated actor delivered ransomware to a mid-sized manu-

facturing company. The intrusion began with a phishing email with a malicious attachment (invoice.docm) sent to finance staff.

2. Intrusion timeline

Opening the document ran powershell.exe, which downloaded payload files from hxxp://update-check[.]xyz/gate.php and from 203.0.113.45.

The actor used stolen credentials, ran a credential dump of LSASS memory and used a command to disable defender on the host.

In a second intrusion set the group exploited CVE-2023-34362 on an internet-facing file transfer server for initial access.

3. Impact

Before encryption the operators had the shadow copies deleted to block recovery. Ransomware encryption then encrypted files across the domain.

Billing and ERP systems were offline for four days and roughly forty servers were affected, including the file servers and finance workstations.

4. Indicators of compromise

SHA-256: e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855. C2 domain: bad-actor[.]com. Sender: admin[at]evil-mail[.]ru.

5. Recommendations

Patch internet-facing systems promptly, enforce multi-factor authentication, keep offline backups and alert on shadow copy deletion.

References: https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1486/ and the CISA advisories were consulted.